

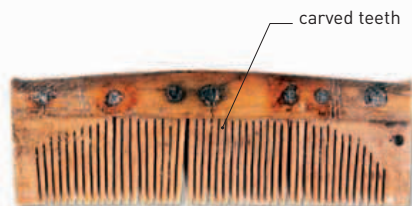
**Buckle plate**

This metal plate was fixed to a Viking's leather belt so that it could be buckled. It has two sections, one for each end of the belt.



ornate etching

lion figure indicates wind direction



carved teeth

Hair comb

A typical Viking grooming kit included a comb, tweezers, and scoops for cleaning ears. This wooden comb has a handle secured with iron rivets.



silver and gold inlay work

Brooch

This box brooch (top view), from Martens on the Swedish island of Gotland, is decorated with four squatting human figures in gold.

**Gilded weather vane**

Weather vanes were originally mounted on the prows of ships and later on the tops of churches. This gilded weather vane was found in Sweden.



stylized great beast with sinuous limbs



iron crest

**Early Danish coins**

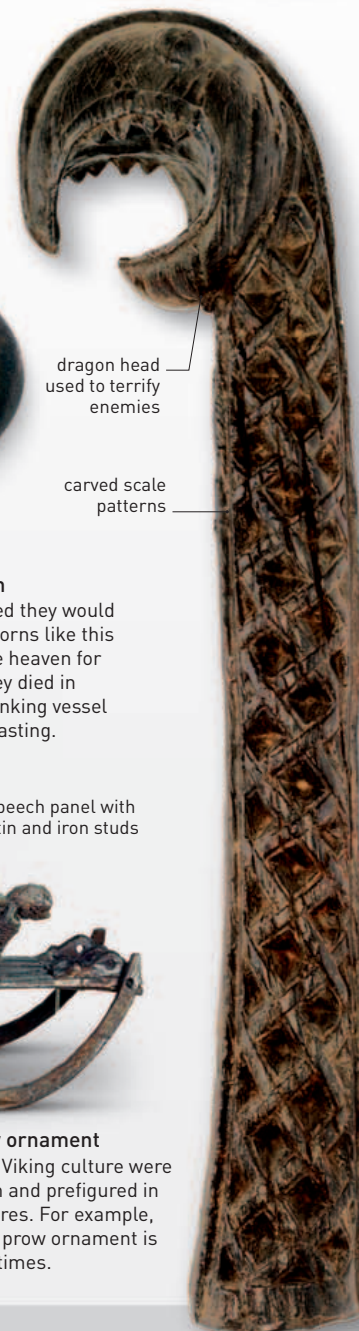
Originally, the Vikings used looted coins, hack silver (chunks), and barter in place of their own money. King Harald Bluetooth started mass minting of coins in 975.

Trading weights

Found in Sweden, these brass-coated iron weights were used to measure quantities of goods and the value of hack silver.



symbol indicates weight



dragon head used to terrify enemies

carved scale patterns



carved from an animal horn

Drinking horn

Vikings believed they would use drinking horns like this in Valhalla, the heaven for warriors, if they died in battle. This drinking vessel was used in feasting.



beech panel with tin and iron studs

Sledge

This oak-and-beech sledge is from a ship burial in Oseberg, Norway. It has finely carved runners and animal heads on each corner post of the box.

Ship's prow ornament

Elements of Viking culture were derived from and prefigured in earlier cultures. For example, this wooden prow ornament is from Saxon times.

Helmet

Made from iron plates welded together over a leather cap, this Norwegian helmet has an attached face guard, complete with nose protector.

face guard